

Texting can kill

A text-messaging-pilot has been found to be the reason for a helicopter crash in Missouri.
<http://dgit.in/YIsFu9>

Even faster Thunderbolt

Thunderbolt data transfer rate to jump from 10Gbps to 20Gbps
<http://dgit.in/10JrkK6>

colours, adjusting black levels, setting picture-in-picture, picture modes and so on. You can even attach video signals from two different sources thereby allowing the monitor to work in dual-link mode – works great as a collaboration tool in meetings. It also bundles in a microUSB to HDMI cable, with which you can connect LG smartphones to the monitor. The Dell S2740L is similar in appearance to its 21.5-inch cousin the S2240L having the same glossy screen, edge-to-edge glass screen, exact same rear design and similar touch-screen controls and OSD menu options. BenQ had two monitors namely XL2720T and GW2760S. The VA panel sporting GW2760S is the elder cousin of the GW2250. We like the thin bezel and the slim profile of the monitor. The OSD menu options are similar to the ones seen on the GW2250, but the OSD buttons are arranged on the bottom right hand corner on the rear side, which makes operations relatively easier.

XL2720T is the flagship 3D gaming monitor from BenQ and it is backed with impressive design. The stand has a rectangular metal handle on top of it for easy lifting of the monitor and just behind the stand is a red coloured extension for holding your headphones – thoughtful. It comes with an S-switch – a mouse-like device which allows you to easily navigate the OSD menu. The OSD options are similar to the ones seen on the XL2411T. It bundles 3D Vision 2 glasses and supports light boost technology. See '3D Gaming Experience' box.

Viewsonic VX2770SMH is the final monitor in this category and it has a very unconventional design. It has an edge-to-edge glass design with a very thin bezel. It has touch controls, but their placement is

very unergonomic, as in you have to tilt the monitor up to be able to operate the controls smoothly.

Build Quality

BenQ XL2720T has the best build quality among all the monitors followed closely by the LG 29EA93. Both these monitors have a very sturdy base and stand. BenQ GW2760HS and Viewsonic VX2770smh tend to wobble a lot on mild tapping. We didn't like the ergonomics of the VX2770smh as it was difficult to reach the OSD touch buttons without tilting the monitor. It is even difficult to attach the display cables on the rear side of the VX2770smh. The Dell S2740L was another monitor whose recessed ports were annoying when it came to attaching display cables.

Performance

We will start with the Lagom.nl tests. In the colour contrast test all monitors performed well except the Viewsonic VX2770smh, in which the last two blocks of pink and red colours merged. In the rest of the monitors, each colour block was clearly distinguishable. We were quite impressed with Dell S2740L's performance in the white saturation test, where each white block was clearly distinguishable from the white background – a feat achieved by no other monitor in the entire test. The Pixel walk test performance was impressive in this category, with BenQ GW2760HS, LG 29EA93P and Viewsonic VX2770smh giving a flicker-free output in all the 11 patterns. Barring the BenQ mon-



BenQ GW 2760HS

itors, all other monitors gave brilliant viewing angles from all directions. With the BenQ GW2760HS and XL2720T, we noticed major colour shifting when we viewed the monitor scene from the bottom up.

Coming to the Spyder 3 Elite tests, we got the best contrast ratio on the BenQ GW2760HS – a whopping 1338.57:1 at 50 per cent brightness levels and 1311.81:1 at 100 per cent brightness levels. The XL2720T followed this with an impressive 724.8:1 at 50 per cent brightness levels. The black levels on the BenQ GW2760HS were brilliant with a black luminance value of just 0.14

whereas the black level on the LG 29EA93P was around 0.33. The Viewsonic VX2770smh registered the lowest contrast ratio in this segment.

The high contrast ratio on the BenQ monitors was retitrated when we were watching HD movies on these monitors. The level of detailing was quite impressive in Avatar and colours appeared natural. Only in the movie modes of these monitors did we experience a higher bias towards blue. The LG 29EA93P will show vertical black bars, on the side of a full HD movie which is in a 16:9 aspect ratio, but since we had a wide aspect ratio version of Skyfall, the entire screen real estate of the 29EA93P was filled with the movie. The fast action scenes looked really good and we didn't find any sort of noise or banding in scenes involving solid colour backgrounds. Even while playing games, the wide-screen of the LG monitor gives a wonderful experience, specially in car racing games and third person shooters. In ambient light, Dell S2740L's glossy screen becomes like a mirror whenever there is a dark scene but it does maintain detail and manages fast action scenes quite well. Viewsonic VX2770smh also performed quite well with the HD movies.



LG 29EA93-P